

Is Your Smartphone Really 'Smart'?

You have plenty of options across various smartphone brands, but just as with any other consumer device, these are likely to leave you confused



Motorola Defy Plus smartphone

PRIY PANDIT

We all must have had a feature phone at some point in our lives. Besides offering basic telephony and messaging features, these 'light on pocket' phones now come with some smartphone-like functions too. Over the years, tight

competition in the market has made smartphones more affordable to own. More and more consumers are now coming forward to buy a smartphone instead of a basic phone and do not hesitate to shell out a few extra bucks for that.

Within a budget of Rs 15,000, you can get a decently configured smartphone to suit your needs. However, the more moolah you pump-in, the

sweeter will be the deal for you. But before you finalise the deal, be sure to carefully assess your needs and the features of the smartphone of your choice. The following factors will help you make the best choice out of the rest.

Utility

Ask yourself "What do you want out of your mobile phone?" Unlike basic phones, smartphones are powerful devices. A mid-level smartphone may offer you the utility of your laptop or desktop. Coupled with mighty processors and large touchscreen form factors, these devices let you handle multiple e-mail accounts, read/edit documents, browse the Internet and multi-task between apps with complete ease.

Surpassing the slower 2G standards, smartphones now support 3G standard by default (a few support 4G too), which allows blazing fast Internet access and video telephony. Fulfilling the needs of shutterbugs, several smartphones sport high-end cameras (numerous offering dual-camera too) with advanced features that were earlier available in digital cameras only. Smartphones run detail-rich operating systems and give access to a plethora of apps across a variety of segments such as finance, health, productivity, security, news and entertainment.

Processor

Just like with your desktop or laptop, a processor acts like the brain of a smartphone. Recently, smartphones with compelling quad-core processors and hefty price points, such as the Samsung Galaxy S III and HTC One X, have entered the market. But the